COMPANY XYZ

Employee Handbook & Guide

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Version 3.2

This document is a fictional company handbook created for software testing purposes. Company XYZ is not a real organization.

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1. Welcome to Company XYZ

Welcome to Company XYZ! We're excited to have you join our team. Company XYZ was founded in 2011 with a simple mission: to build reliable, easy-to-use software tools for small businesses. Today we employ over 400 people across three offices — Denver, Austin, and a fully remote engineering team distributed across North America.

This handbook explains our policies, benefits, and expectations. It applies to all full-time, part-time, and contract employees unless otherwise noted. Please read it carefully and reach out to People Operations (peopleops@companyxyz.example) with any questions.

1.1 Our Values

Be Direct, Be Kind: We give honest feedback delivered with respect.

Own the Outcome: We take responsibility for results, not just effort.

Default to Transparency: We share information openly unless there's a specific reason not to.

Build for the Long Term: We favor sustainable decisions over short-term wins.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Classifications

Employees at Company XYZ fall into one of the following categories, which determine eligibility for benefits described in this guide:

- **Full-Time:** Regularly scheduled for 32+ hours per week. Eligible for full benefits.
- **Part-Time:** Regularly scheduled for fewer than 32 hours per week. Eligible for prorated PTO only.
- **Contract:** Engaged for a defined project or period. Not eligible for company benefits unless specified in the contract.
- **Intern:** Temporary employment, typically tied to an academic term. Eligible for sick leave only.

2.2 Work Hours & Schedule

Standard core business hours are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday. Employees may flex their start and end times around this core window, provided they complete their standard 40-hour week (or prorated equivalent for part-time staff) and attend required meetings.

2.3 Dress Code

Company XYZ maintains a casual dress code in all offices. Employees should dress appropriately for their scheduled activities — business casual attire is expected for client-facing meetings or events representing the company.

2.4 Probationary Period

New full-time and part-time employees serve a 90-day introductory period beginning on their start date. During this period, either the employee or Company XYZ may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause. Benefits eligibility (health insurance, 401(k) matching) begins on the first day of the month following completion of the introductory period.

3. Compensation

3.1 Pay Schedule

Employees are paid semi-monthly, on the 15th and last business day of each month, via direct deposit. Pay stubs are available through the ADP employee portal.

3.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are paid 1.5x their regular hourly rate for hours worked beyond 40 in a single work week, in accordance with applicable federal and state law. Overtime must be approved in advance by a manager. Exempt (salaried) employees are not eligible for overtime pay.

3.3 Annual Compensation Review

Compensation is reviewed annually each October as part of the performance review cycle described in Section 8. Adjustments, when made, take effect with the first pay period of the following January.

3.4 Referral Bonuses

Employees who refer a candidate who is hired and completes 90 days of employment receive a $1,500 referral bonus for standard roles, or $3,000 for hard-to-fill engineering and leadership roles.

4. Paid Time Off & Leave Policies

4.1 Vacation (PTO) Accrual

Full-time employees accrue paid vacation time based on years of service, as shown below. PTO accrues monthly and is prorated for part-time employees based on scheduled hours.

Years of Service	Annual PTO Accrual	Monthly Accrual	Max Rollover
0 – 2 years	15 days	1.25 days	5 days
3 – 5 years	20 days	1.67 days	8 days
6 – 9 years	23 days	1.92 days	10 days
10+ years	25 days	2.08 days	10 days

PTO requests should be submitted at least two weeks in advance through the HR portal for approval by your manager. Unused PTO above the maximum rollover amount is forfeited at year-end, except where prohibited by state law.

4.2 Sick Leave

All employees, including interns and part-time staff, accrue 1 hour of paid sick leave for every 30 hours worked, up to a maximum of 48 hours per calendar year. Sick leave may be used for the employee's own illness, medical appointments, or to care for an immediate family member.

4.3 Company Holidays

Company XYZ observes 10 paid holidays per year:

- New Year's Day
- Memorial Day
- Juneteenth
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Day after Thanksgiving
- Christmas Eve
- Christmas Day
- Floating Holiday (employee's choice)

4.4 Parental Leave

Employees who have completed the introductory period are eligible for 12 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Leave must be taken within 12 months of the qualifying event and may be taken continuously or intermittently with manager approval.

4.5 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 paid days for the death of an immediate family member and up to 2 paid days for the death of an extended family member or close friend.

5. Health & Retirement Benefits

5.1 Health Insurance

Company XYZ offers medical, dental, and vision coverage through Meridian Health Partners, effective the first of the month following completion of the 90-day introductory period. Company XYZ covers 80% of the employee premium and 60% of dependent premiums across three plan tiers:

Plan	Employee Monthly Cost	Deductible	Notes
PPO Standard	$45	$1,500	Broad network, no referrals needed
PPO Plus	$95	$500	Lower deductible, wider specialist access
HDHP + HSA	$15	$3,000	Paired with company HSA contribution of $600/yr

5.2 401(k) Retirement Plan

Employees may enroll in the Company XYZ 401(k) plan, administered by Fidelity, immediately upon hire. Company XYZ matches 100% of employee contributions up to 4% of salary, and 50% of the next 2%, for a maximum total match of 5%. Matching contributions vest immediately.

5.3 Additional Perks

- $1,000 annual professional development stipend (courses, conferences, books)
- $75/month remote work stipend for internet and home office expenses
- Free mental health support through Lyra Health (up to 8 sessions/year)
- Annual company retreat
- Pet insurance discount program (employee-paid, company-negotiated rate)

6. Workplace Conduct & Regulations

6.1 Anti-Harassment & Non-Discrimination

Company XYZ is committed to providing a work environment free from harassment and discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, or any other legally protected characteristic. Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment or discrimination should report it immediately to their manager, People Operations, or through the confidential ethics hotline.

6.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose any outside employment, financial interest, or personal relationship that could reasonably conflict with Company XYZ's interests. Disclosure forms are available from People Operations and must be submitted annually or when a new conflict arises.

6.3 Confidentiality

All employees are required to sign a confidentiality and invention assignment agreement upon hire. Confidential information — including customer data, source code, financial results, and product roadmaps — may not be shared outside the company without authorization, and remains confidential after employment ends.

6.4 Drug-Free Workplace

Company XYZ maintains a drug-free workplace policy. Employees may not report to work under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs. Use of cannabis, even where legal, is prohibited during work hours or on company property.

6.5 Progressive Discipline

Company XYZ generally follows a progressive discipline process — verbal warning, written warning, final written warning, termination — for performance or conduct issues. Company XYZ reserves the right to skip steps or terminate immediately for serious misconduct, including but not limited to theft, harassment, safety violations, or falsification of records.

7. Remote Work & Technology Policy

7.1 Remote Work Eligibility

Roles are designated as Office-Based, Hybrid (minimum 2 days/week in-office), or Fully Remote. Designation is set at the time of hire based on role requirements and may be revisited with manager and People Operations approval.

7.2 Equipment

Company XYZ provides a laptop and standard peripherals to all employees. Remote employees may request a one-time $300 home office setup reimbursement (desk, chair, monitor) during their first 90 days.

7.3 Acceptable Use

Company-issued devices and accounts are intended primarily for business use. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work, violate company policy, or involve illegal activity. IT reserves the right to monitor company systems for security purposes.

7.4 Data Security

Employees must use company-approved password managers and enable multi-factor authentication on all business accounts. Customer and company data may not be stored on personal devices or personal cloud storage accounts.

8. Performance Reviews & Career Growth

8.1 Review Cycle

Formal performance reviews occur annually each October, with an informal check-in at the six-month mark each April. New employees receive an initial review after their first 90 days.

8.2 Rating Scale

- **Exceeds Expectations:** Consistently exceeds goals and role expectations.
- **Meets Expectations:** Reliably meets goals and role expectations.
- **Partially Meets Expectations:** Inconsistent performance; improvement plan may be initiated.
- **Does Not Meet Expectations:** Performance falls short of role requirements; formal improvement plan required.

8.3 Internal Mobility

Employees are encouraged to apply for internal openings after 12 months in their current role. Managers are asked to support internal transfers rather than act as a barrier to employee growth.

9. Separation of Employment

9.1 Voluntary Resignation

Employees who choose to resign are asked to provide at least two weeks' written notice to their manager and People Operations to support a smooth transition.

9.2 Final Pay & Benefits

Final paychecks, including payout of accrued and unused PTO, are issued in accordance with state law. Health insurance coverage ends on the last day of the month in which employment ends, with COBRA continuation coverage information provided within 14 days.

9.3 Exit Interviews

People Operations will schedule an exit interview for all departing employees to gather feedback on their experience at Company XYZ. Participation is voluntary but encouraged.

10. Contacts & Resources

Department	Contact	Purpose
People Operations	peopleops@companyxyz.example	Benefits, policy questions, leave requests
IT Help Desk	ithelp@companyxyz.example	Equipment, accounts, security issues
Payroll	payroll@companyxyz.example	Pay, tax forms, direct deposit
Ethics Hotline	1-800-555-0199 (24/7, confidential)	Report concerns anonymously

This handbook is provided for informational purposes and does not constitute an employment contract. Company XYZ reserves the right to modify these policies at any time.